

Tiffany Mao

PRODUCT DESIGNER

An engineer-brained Product Designer crafting playful, human-centered products that balance technical rigor with memorable and delightful user experiences.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Freelance Product Designer / TimeWith.xyz

JAN 2025 – Present / Freelance, Remote

- Established the company's first design system, including comprehensive dark/light mode tokens, 20+ reusable components, and brand guidelines, enabling consistent UI development for a scheduling platform serving consultants and coaches.
- Delivered complete brand identity and high-fidelity calendar management and meeting booking flow UI designs for 0→1 product, working closely with founder to balance startup constraints with professional polish.

Product Designer / Cocoon Financial Services

APRIL 2023 – JUNE 2024 / Full-time, San Francisco

- Owned the design process for pregnancy disability features, leading end-to-end UX design from concept and coding to launch, enabling new leave types for 1K+ users.
- Conducted user interviews and collaborated with legal and operations teams to integrate product solutions with business objectives.
- Established the company's first design system, streamlining design language across platforms and enhancing consistency by 40%.
- Spearheaded first brand refresh initiative, enhancing visual coherence and ensuring ADA compliance across all user touchpoints.

Software Engineer / Meta

SEPT 2022 – NOV 2022 / Full-time, Menlo Park

- Revamped Android UI components for Facebook's video sharing team, improving accessibility and reducing design inconsistencies by 30%.
- Designed and developed React components in Figma for Meta's internal pipeline management tool, streamlining user workflows and reducing reverted changes by 50%.
- Enhanced visual graphics for Meta's Figma plugins to optimize color and text accessibility, ensuring compliance with WCAG accessibility standards.

iOS Software Engineer Intern / Meta

JUNE 2021 – AUG 2021 / Intern, Remote

- Created components for cross-posting stories between Facebook and Instagram, producing a design-accurate eligibility page accessed by millions.

PROJECTS

The Wonder Workshop (Tutorial & Core Loop)

Spring 2026, UC Berkeley · MDes Collaboration with Common Sense Media · 6 weeks

Educational crafting game for children ages 9–11, integrating UX onboarding with hands-on material exploration

- Designed the core interaction model around three distinct material-based characters—each critter serving as both a narrative guide and a UX onboarding mechanism, teaching color theory, texture, and form through embedded, non-interruptive tutorials before the player begins crafting.
- Architected a zero-failure-state progression system, replacing punitive evaluation with a scrapbook order-book mechanic that archives each completed piece, prioritizing intrinsic motivation and re-engagement over scoring to drive session retention for ages 9–11.

PalBits – Customizable Game Controller

September 2025, UC Berkeley

Modular handheld controller enabling children to customize in-game character evolution

- Synthesized industrial design (3D-printed ergonomic housing), hardware integration (button systems, LED displays), and game mechanics (discrete RPG progression) into cohesive experience balancing self-expression with usability for ages 8–12.
- Designed modular interaction system where swappable controller bits (wands, accessories) unlock corresponding in-game character skills and visual evolution on LED screen, addressing children's need for tangible feedback and autonomy.



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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Design, MDES
Expected Graduation 2026

University of California, Berkeley

Bachelor of Arts,
Computer Science
2022

SKILLS

UI/UX
Design System
Branding
Prototyping
Wireframing
User Research
Usability Testing
User Journey
User Interviews
A/B Testing
Data Analysis
Accessibility
3D Modeling
Computer-Aided Design
Artificial Intelligence
LLM System Design
API Integration
Prompt Engineering
Micro-controllers
Physical Fabrication

TOOLS

Figma
Balsamiq
Adobe CC
Illustrator
HTML/CSS
JavaScript
Miro
Cursor
Vercel
ChatGPT / Claude
Fusion 360
Prusa
p5.js
Python
Arduino

